Graeme and Neil knock off the nine runs required to win in seven balls, and we win the Test by 10 wickets with a day to spare.

Saturday, 2 August 2008

This may be the most enjoyable fines meeting in the history of South African cricket. It is nearing midnight, more than five hours after victory in the third Test in Birmingham gave us a winning 2–0 lead in the four-Test series, and the Proteas are still in the visitors' changing room at Edgbaston, still celebrating together.

I look around and feel so pleased, pleased for Mickey Arthur and his coaches who have worked so hard for this historic series win, pleased for Graeme, Jacques and Bouch, pleased for the other players and management, pleased for the whole group because we have made history together, becoming the first South African squad to win a Test series in England in the modern era. Right here, amid the laughter and the sweat-stained kit, the shared joy and weariness, the warm glow of collective satisfaction, lies the essence of team sport.

These moments are so precious because it is the hope and belief that such moments lie ahead that drives us, as individuals and as a squad, through the tough times, through all the travel and training, and because it is the memory of these moments that will remain with each of us for the rest of our lives.

I look around the changing room, and feel so blessed and so privileged.

Neil McKenzie is in full flow, running the fines meeting with Mark Boucher.

'Jacques Kallis, come forward please,' he says. 'We all know you have given so much to this team. You have even given most of your hair. Graeme usually makes you bowl into the wind and you always do as he asks, even though you know very well it will make your hairline recede even faster.'